

"Shane has the ability to mould himself into any character he is playing. He could become a great actor if he keeps improving"

SHAJI N. KARUN
Director

METHOD AND MADNESS

SHANE NIGAM, 25

Actor

Shane Nigam started off as a child artist in 2007, doing the rounds of reality TV shows and serials. By 2013, he was appearing in small roles in Malayalam films but his first big break came three years later when he was cast as the lead in the Shanavas K. Bavakutty-directed feature, *Kismath*. The film didn't exactly set the box office on fire but his performance was well received and led to roles in commercial and critical hits like *Paravaa* and *c/o Saira Banu*. Then came 2019 and the Madhu C. Narayan-directed *Kumbalangi Nights*, where his performance as the moody brother Bobby in a dysfunctional family won the appreciation of both fans and filmmakers. This was followed by hits like *Ishq*, and a role in film auteur Shaji N. Karun's *Oolu*. Now he has half a dozen films lined up for release.

Nigam is also a trained dancer with a passion for western dance, choreographed sessions of which he often posts on social media. He also courted controversy in 2020 after producers of three movies lodged complaints against him for not cooperating in post-production work. Malayalam superstar Mohanlal had to intervene to save him from a ban. ■

–Jeemon Jacob

MUM'S THE WORLD Shane is very close to his mother, and quite often uses her social media accounts to post his pictures and videos